

Read this first

Ask before you explain. Explain only after they've tried.

Floating forks	Centre of mass
Say	"Make two forks hang off the glass. Only the toothpick may touch it."
Ask first	"Where is the balance point of the forks? Point at it."
After: explain	The heavy handles curve back under the toothpick, so the balance point of the whole shape ends up just below the rim. When the balance point hangs below the support, the shape swings back instead of falling.
Look around	Find something hanging: a coat on a hook or a lamp. Its heavy part settles below the point that holds it.
Close with	"Where did the balance point turn out to be?"

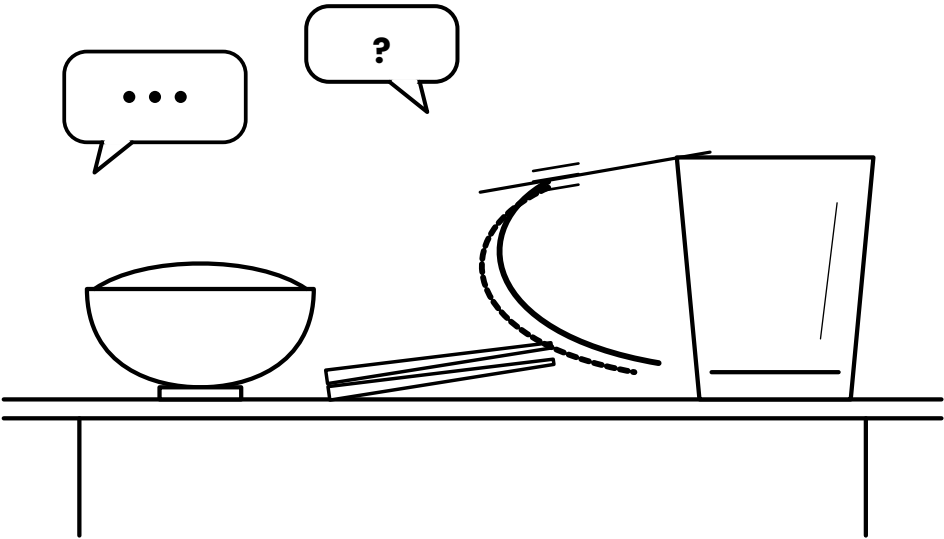
Table talks	Conversation, not a quiz
Your job	Read the question, then guess too. Kids love it when a grown-up is wrong.
Follow up	After each answer, ask one "why do you think...?" and let the silence sit for a moment.
Stop	When the food arrives, put the booklet away. If the talk keeps going, it worked.
Allergies	If your child or a friend has an allergy, this page is a good moment to let them explain it in their own words.

Safety Use an empty glass. Keep toothpick points away from faces.

Waiting for food

Restaurant: 1 quiet challenge, 3 table talks

Ages 9 to 12



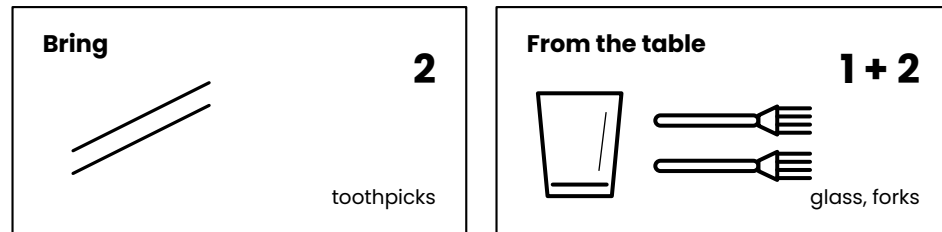
Order. Put the phones away. Talk.

Grown-ups: start on the back page.



Tonight's plan

Talk more than you build.



How it works

- 1 After you order: the quiet challenge, about 10 minutes.
- 2 Then pick a table talk that fits this restaurant.
- 3 Food arrives: booklet away, keep the talk going.

Which talk?

Chopsticks	Chinese restaurant	page 5
Table manners	Chinese restaurant	page 6
Food allergies	Any restaurant	page 7

Talk rules

Everyone guesses out loud before anyone checks.
A wild guess is a good guess.
Answers are upside down at the bottom of each page.

Food allergies

Why can one peanut matter?

What happens

Your body has a defence team that fights germs. In a food allergy, it mistakes a harmless part of a food for an invader and overreacts: itchy skin, swelling, and sometimes serious trouble breathing.

Allergy or intolerance?

Some people's stomachs struggle to digest the sugar in milk. That is an intolerance: uncomfortable, but the defence team is not involved.

Menu detective

In the EU, restaurants must tell you if a dish contains any of these 14. Find how this menu shows them, or ask. Guess which ones are in your order.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Gluten (wheat, rye...) | ☐ Crustaceans (prawns, crab) |
| ☐ Eggs | ☐ Fish |
| ☐ Peanuts | ☐ Soy |
| ☐ Milk | ☐ Tree nuts |
| ☐ Celery | ☐ Mustard |
| ☐ Sesame | ☐ Sulphites |
| ☐ Lupin | ☐ Molluscs (mussels, squid) |

Talk about it

A friend with a nut allergy joins us. What do we ask the waiter?

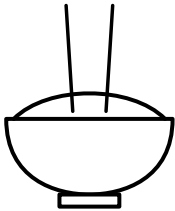
Did you know? In a large study, babies who regularly ate peanut foods from early on were far less likely to become allergic to peanuts.

Curiosity, not medical advice. Always follow your own doctor.

Table manners

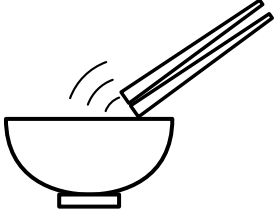
Guess why each one matters

A



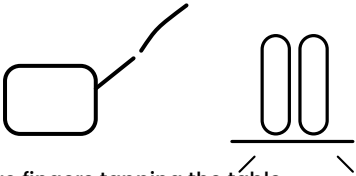
Chopsticks standing up in rice
Why not?

B



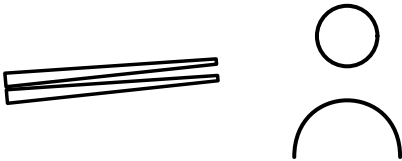
Tapping the bowl with chopsticks
Why not?

C



Two fingers tapping the table
What does it mean?

D



Pointing with chopsticks
Why not?

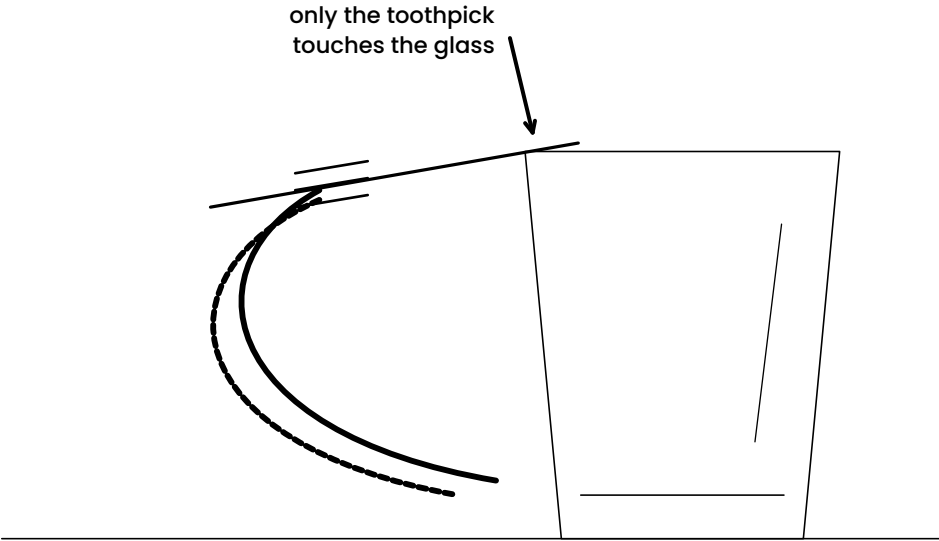
Which rule do we have at home too?

Answers

A: Upright chopsticks look like incense sticks placed for people who have died.
B: Long ago, beggars tapped their bowls to ask for food.
C: A quiet "thank you" when someone pours your tea. A story says it began with an emperor travelling in disguise.
D: Pointing at people is rude. Rest chopsticks on the holder or across your bowl instead.

Floating forks

10 minutes



Levels

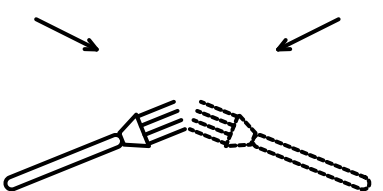
- Hangs off the rim for 5 seconds
- Only the very tip of the toothpick on the rim
- No glass: balance it on a fingertip

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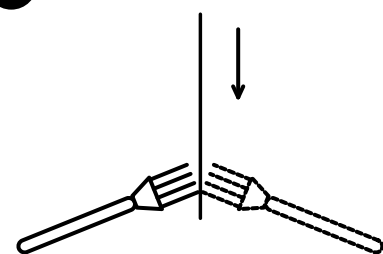
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1



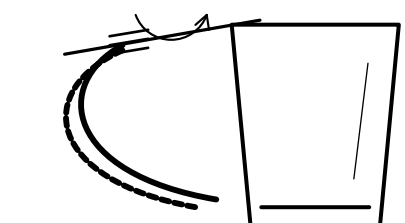
Push the tines together

2



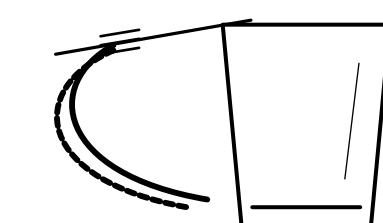
Toothpick between the tines

3



Tip on the rim, adjust

4



Let go slowly

5 Point at the spot where it balances.



Chopsticks

3,000 years of picking things up



- 1** How old are the oldest chopsticks ever found?
 - (a) About 300 years
 - (b) About 1,000 years
 - (c) About 3,000 years
- 2** What were the first chopsticks mostly used for?
 - (a) Eating rice
 - (b) Cooking and reaching into hot pots
 - (c) Writing
- 3** Chopsticks used to be called zhù. Why do people now say kuàizi?
 - (a) Zhù sounded like "stop", bad luck on a boat
 - (b) An emperor banned the old word
 - (c) Kuàizi was easier to write

When the food arrives

Who can pick up a single grain of rice with chopsticks?

Answers

1: c. Bronze chopsticks about 3,000 years old were dug up at the ruins of Yin, near Anyang in China.

2: b. They started as cooking tools. People began eating with them much later, around 2,000 years ago.

3: a. A popular story says boatmen about 500 years ago avoided zhù because it sounds like "stop". They said kuài, "fast", instead.